

fitting definition. Most people argue that a simplistic definition like the one above belittles the impact of cloud-based computing in the real world, but the truth is that cloud computing is actually just jargon, a scientific concept, inclusive of a whole lot of computing frameworks. Larry Ellison famously commented, “The interesting thing about cloud computing is that we’ve redefined cloud computing to include everything that we already do. I can’t



think of anything that isn’t cloud computing with all of these announcements. The computer industry is the only industry that is more fashion-driven than women’s fashion”. The above does a more than better job of asserting the computing spread that cloud computing provides. Cloud computing includes some forms of distributed

computing which is basically running a program or application on several machines connected to the internet at the same time. But the phrase is more commonly used to describe the practice of utilising a service over a network using software running on a single or multiple machines on the service provider’s side. Let’s, drill this in using an example. Say you want to run an intensive computer program using only your low end netbook. You can either spend a small fortune and purchase a supercomputer or make use of a cloud computing platform, port your code and allow it to be processed on the cloud (a set of high end machine + software combinations on the service provider’s side). Post processing you can obtain the results in a few clicks. What you have achieved here is the service of powerful processors that are not physically connected to your system, but are a part of the same network (the Internet, in this case).

“Cloud” computing

The word “Cloud” in cloud computing has an interesting take to it. The fact is “Cloud” Computing is so little understood that an explanation is warranted. A cloud refers to a set of hardware, networks and storage devices with combined capability of providing *any* useful service. A Cloud